



Lesser is better

Apple devices can be really confusing to navigate and use. Here's another instance to prove the point.
<http://dgit.in/PixelMom>

Google Vs Apple

Alphabet (or Google) has clinched the top for being the most valued company pushing down Apple this year.
<http://dgit.in/AVsG>

Bazaar

BlackBerry Priv

Great smartphone but expensive

The beauty of the world of technology is that no company stays on top forever. BlackBerry, once the ideal weapon of choice for the business man is now struggling. Can the Priv save it?

Hold the phone in your hands and you know that you are holding a premium product. Slide the keyboard a couple of times and you know that the slider is of top notch quality. BlackBerry expects you to take the smooth keyboard slider for granted and it shows with the quality of materials used.

Once you slide the BlackBerry Privs keyboard you'd expect the smartphone to be unbalanced but surprisingly it isn't. Its quite comfortable to hold and if you have used a BlackBerry keyboard in the past, you will definitely feel at home on this device. Speaking of the overall build quality, the BlackBerry Priv can give any other flagship you can think off a run for its money.

The display on the Priv's curved at the edges too (when held in portrait mode). The cure isn't as obvious as the one on the Samsung Galaxy S6 Edge Plus but its presence is evident nonetheless. The overall performance of the display is great too be it for watching movies, playing games or good old social media, mail and messages.

The onscreen keyboard is similar to the stock Android keyboard with a few differences. Predictive words appear as you start typing and you can simply swipe up to chose the predicted word. The slide out keyboard on the Priv, is comfortable to use. It's a throwback to the good old BlackBerry days with the gesture capabilities of the BlackBerry Passport thrown into the mix.

Coming to everyday performance, the phone works well. It will run any app that you throw at it with absolute ease. The only downside is that the smartphone gets quite hot after some use. I watched a few YouTube videos, played Asphalt 8 for a bit and sent a few messages and email and the device was quite hot. Hot enough to be uncomfortable when I put the phone in my jeans pocket.



Price
₹62,990

Moving to the call quality, the audio from the loudspeaker are well as the earpiece is crisp and clear. When talking a call through the earpiece, I recommend you monitor the volume. At full volume the earpiece is really loud. Loud enough to be the loudspeaker in a quiet room and that can be a disadvantage if you are surrounded by eavesdroppers.

Despite having a 3410mAh battery, the battery life of the BlackBerry Priv is a little disappointing. With mails, messages, some YouTubeing and light gaming, the device had less than 30% battery at the end of the day.

The big deal with the BlackBerry Priv is that its running a 'close to stock' version of Android with BlackBerry apps thrown into the mix. You have customized notifications and widgets, and

BlackBerry apps like the Hub and DTEK for security make an appearance on the device too. BlackBerry says that they will roll out monthly updates for the phone to keep it up to date with software and security.

Coming to the camera, the short story here is that the low light photography is good but in well lit situations, the images are soft and there is loss of detail when you see the image in their full size.

The BlackBerry Priv is a great smartphone with a few shortcomings. It heats up, there is no fingerprint sensor which is taken for granted today and the smartphone launched in India almost a year after its international release. The front facing camera isn't great when compared to the competition in today's selfie driven world. On the plus side, it has the best display on a smartphone, the curved display is brilliant, the typing experience is great and the overall Android performance with BlackBerry thrown into the mix is great for BlackBerry fans and newcomers alike. Will you shift from your current phone to a Priv? Well only if you are a fan boy or you have some way of getting this device at a discount. For the price you pay, you may want to consider your options before investing.

Sameer Mitha



Features 75
Design 89
Performance 71
Value for money 50

Specifications

Display: 5.4-inch AMOLED display with a 2560x1440 pixel resolution; **OS:** Android OS, v5.1.1 (Lollipop); **CPU:** Qualcomm Snapdragon 808, Dual-core 1.8GHz & quad-core 1.44GHz; **GPU:** Adreno 418; **RAM:** 3GB; **Storage:** 32GB built-in expandable up to 2TB via a microSD card; **Camera:** 18MP rear/2MP front; **Battery:** Non-removable Li-Ion 3410 mAh

Contact

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